HISTORICAL NOTE: Despite their drawbacks, war elephants were immensely popular from the era of the Diadochi (Alexander's successors) through the days of the Roman Republic (even the Romans used them—cf. Cynoscephalae— although not often). By the time of Pyrrhus, war elephants became equipped with "towers" and their compatriot cavalry had also become trained to work alongside them. Unfortunately, the flexibility of the Roman legion system eventually negated their advantages, leaving them with a host of disadvantages which doomed them as relics.